

Tabletop Collection Manager - Product Requirements Document

Contents

Tabletop Collection Manager — Product Requirements Document

1. Product Summary
2. Target Users
3. Product Goals
4. MVP Scope
5. MVP Non-Goals
6. Core Product Concepts
7. Collection Management Requirements
8. Shelves
9. Find a Game / Play Decision Experience
10. Ratings and Reactions
11. Play Logging
12. Player Profiles and Session Sharing
13. Collection Health Insights
14. Data Model Proposal
15. BoardGameGeek Mapping Proposal
16. CSV Import and Export
17. Privacy, Accounts, Security, and Data Control
18. MVP Screen Inventory
19. Navigation Diagram
20. Key User Flow Diagrams
21. Key Product Considerations
22. Research and Validation Plan
23. MVP Success Metrics

- 24. Proposed Definition of Done for MVP
- 25. Agent Role for Future Product Work
- 26. Open Questions
- 27. Recommended Next Step

Tabletop Collection Manager — Product Requirements Document

1. Product Summary

Working Product Concept

A mobile-first responsive web app for tabletop game collectors and players to organize their current collections, manage shelves, track plays, and decide what to play.

The product begins as a clean, utility-focused collection database with light agent assistance layered in where useful. It is not intended to start as a public social network, marketplace, or BoardGameGeek replacement.

Core Product Thesis

Tabletop gamers need a better way to answer:

What do I own, how is it organized, what have I played, and what should we play next?

The MVP should help users manage their existing collection and make that collection more useful through shelves, filters, play tracking, player profiles, ratings, and collection-health insights.

Positioning Statement

A private-first tabletop collection manager that helps players organize what they own, understand their collection, and choose the right game for the right group.

2. Target Users

The product is for tabletop game collectors and players, ranging from casual family/game-night players to more invested hobby gamers who want to build, organize, and manage a useful collection.

Provisional Personas

These personas are assumptions for the MVP and should be refined through research.

Persona	Description	Primary Need
Casual Family Organizer	Owns games for family use and needs quick ways to find games that fit age, time, and player count.	"What can we play with this group tonight?"
Hobby Collector	Owns a growing collection and wants better organization, filtering, ratings, and metadata.	"How do I manage and make sense of my collection?"
Game Night Host	Frequently chooses games for different groups of people.	"What game fits this group, time, and mood?"
Data Tracker	Cares about accurate records, play history, ratings, exports, and collection insights.	"What have I played, who with, and how did it go?"
Collection Pruner	Wants to identify games to sell, trade, revisit, or retire.	"What should stay in my collection?"

Persona Review Rule

The product agent should use these personas as a review layer for feature decisions.

For each significant feature idea, ask:

- Which persona benefits most?
- What problem does this solve?
- Is this MVP-critical or a later enhancement?
- How would we know users care?
- Is there a smaller version that could validate the idea?

3. Product Goals

MVP Goals

1. Help users create and manage a cloud-synced tabletop game collection.
2. Allow users to organize games into manual, smart, and hybrid shelves.
3. Support complete enough game metadata to power filtering and recommendations.
4. Let users find something to play using user-controlled filters.
5. Track play sessions with minimum required input and optional richer detail.
6. Support private game ratings and session reactions.
7. Support reusable player profiles, including players without accounts.
8. Allow session sharing so participants can view, confirm, and react.
9. Provide collection-health insights through multiple views.
10. Give users full control over export and deletion of their data.

Design Goals

- Mobile-first responsive web app.
 - Clean utility-focused interface.
 - Fast data entry and management.
 - Clear filtering and sorting.
 - User-controlled organization.
 - Private by default.
 - Stack-agnostic at the PRD stage.
 - Visual design system and tabletop personality can be added later.
-

4. MVP Scope

In Scope for MVP

- User accounts and cloud sync.
- Email/password account creation.
- Google, Apple, and Facebook login.
- Mobile-first responsive web experience.
- Private personal collection.

- Add games manually.
- Add games by matching against BoardGameGeek data.
- CSV import using a prescribed format.
- CSV and JSON export.
- Manual shelves.
- Smart shelves.
- Hybrid shelves.
- Shelf tags and metadata-driven grouping.
- Filter-based collection browsing.
- Filter-based “Find a Game” experience.
- Game detail records with public metadata and user overrides.
- 1–6 die-based game rating.
- Play logging with quick and detailed modes.
- Session reactions: thumbs up, neutral, thumbs down.
- Reusable player profiles.
- Manual and inferred player preferences.
- Session sharing with participants.
- Collection-health insights.
- Data deletion at the record, collection, and account level.

Later Enhancements

- Native iOS and Android apps.
- Full public social network.
- Public reviews and public ratings.
- Public profile pages.
- Friend feeds.
- Marketplace buying, selling, or trading.
- Shared collection editing.
- Barcode scanning.
- Photo-based collection recognition.
- Retailer integrations.
- Publisher integrations.
- Advanced recommendation engine.
- Moderation tools.
- Community forums.

- Rich visual design system.
 - Deep design-system theming.
 - Crowdfunding/preorder tracking beyond simple status.
 - Support for external metadata sources beyond BoardGameGeek and user entry.
-

5. MVP Non-Goals

The MVP should not attempt to provide:

- Public reviews.
 - Public ratings.
 - Full social networking.
 - Marketplace buying/selling/trading.
 - Native mobile apps.
 - Advanced design polish.
 - Complex recommendation algorithms.
 - Retailer or publisher integrations.
 - Shared collection editing.
 - Full moderation tools.
 - Community forums.
 - Universal support for all possible CSV formats.
 - A full BoardGameGeek replacement.
-

6. Core Product Concepts

Collection

A user's collection is the source of truth. Public metadata can enrich a game record, but the user can override imported data.

Game Record

A game record combines:

1. Public metadata from BoardGameGeek, when available.
2. User-specific collection data.

3. User-specific overrides.
4. Shelf membership.
5. Ratings and play history.

Shelves

Shelves are the core organizational concept. A shelf can behave like a manual list, a tag-driven group, a metadata-driven smart list, or a hybrid.

Play Sessions

Play sessions record actual usage of the collection. They can be logged quickly or with rich details.

Player Profiles

Player profiles allow users to log sessions with recurring players even if those players do not have accounts.

Recommendations

Recommendations should be filter-driven and explainable. The user controls the filters, similar to a real estate search experience.

7. Collection Management Requirements

Add Game Methods

The MVP should support:

1. Manual entry.
2. Search/import from BoardGameGeek.
3. CSV import using a prescribed format.

Barcode and photo scan are desirable later enhancements.

Add Game Flow

1. User selects Add Game.
2. User searches by title, enters data manually, or imports via CSV.
3. App attempts to match public metadata from BoardGameGeek.
4. User confirms correct match and edition when possible.

5. App autofills required fields.
6. User reviews missing or incorrect fields.
7. User selects ownership status and play status.
8. App auto-assigns smart shelves.
9. App suggests manual shelves.
10. User saves the game.

Required Game Fields

Required does not mean tedious. The app should autofill as much as possible and only ask the user to complete fields that are missing or user-specific.

Field	Preferred Source	User Editable
Title	BoardGameGeek or user	Yes
Ownership status	User	Yes
Play status	User	Yes
Player count	BoardGameGeek	Yes
Age range	BoardGameGeek	Yes
Play time	BoardGameGeek	Yes
Complexity / teach difficulty	BoardGameGeek or user	Yes
Shelf assignment	Smart rules and user	Yes
Game type / mechanics	BoardGameGeek	Yes
Publisher	BoardGameGeek	Yes

Ownership Status

Supported ownership statuses:

- Owned
- Wishlist
- Borrowed
- Lent Out
- For Trade / Sell
- Previously Owned
- Preordered / Crowdfunded

Play Status

Supported play statuses:

- Unplayed
 - Played Once
 - Actively Played
 - Retired
 - Campaign in Progress
-

8. Shelves

Shelf Types

Shelf Type	Description	Example
Manual Shelf	User manually adds/removes games.	"Games Karen Likes"
Tag-Based Shelf	Based on user-applied tags.	Games tagged "family-friendly"
Metadata-Driven Smart Shelf	Generated from game properties.	2–4 players, under 45 minutes
Hybrid Shelf	Rules plus manual pinning/exclusion.	Quick family games with manual adjustments

Default Shelf Categories

Ownership / Status Shelves

- All Games
- Owned
- Wishlist
- Borrowed
- Lent Out
- For Trade / Sell
- Previously Owned
- Preordered / Crowdfunded

Age Group Shelves

- Preschool / Young Kids

- Kids
- Tweens
- Teens
- Adults
- All Ages
- Family Friendly

Player Count Shelves

- Solo
- Two-Player
- Small Group: 3–4
- Game Night: 4–6
- Party: 6+
- Best at 2
- Best at 4
- Scales Well

Played-Data Shelves

- Unplayed
- Played Once
- Recently Played
- Not Played Recently
- Most Played
- Needs Another Play
- Favorites
- Low-Rated / Cull Candidates

Game Type / Context Shelves

- Quick Games
- Long Games
- Easy Teach
- Heavy Games
- Cooperative
- Competitive
- Campaign / Legacy
- Party Games

- Travel / Portable
- Table Hog
- High Setup

Metadata Shelves

- Publisher
- Designer
- Mechanic
- Theme
- Series / Franchise
- Base Game + Expansions
- Edition / Version
- Language
- Condition

Shelf Assignment During Add Game

When a user adds a game, the app should:

1. Automatically place the game in relevant smart shelves.
2. Suggest manual shelves based on existing shelf patterns.
3. Allow the user to create a new shelf during the add flow.
4. Allow the user to remove or override shelf placement.

Example:

Add Game: Wingspan

Auto-assigned smart shelves:

- Owned
- 1-5 Players
- Family Friendly
- Medium Complexity
- Engine Building
- Stonemaier Games

Suggested manual shelves:

- Favorites
- Teach Soon
- Bring to Game Night
- Nature-Themed Games

9. Find a Game / Play Decision Experience

Core Principle

The user controls recommendation criteria through filters. The system should not be an opaque recommender.

Filter Categories

Filter Group	Examples
Players	2 players, 3–4 players, 6+ players, best at selected count
Time	Under 30 minutes, 30–60 minutes, 60–120 minutes
Age Fit	Kids, tweens, teens, adults, family-friendly
Complexity	Easy teach, medium, heavy, expert
Energy / Mood	Chill, funny, thinky, competitive, cooperative
Status	Unplayed, recently played, not played in a while, favorites
Collection	Owned, borrowed, wishlist, expansion available
People	Good with specific players or groups
Practical	Portable, low setup, high setup, table hog, campaign in progress

Recommendation Explanation

Every recommendation should explain why it matches the current filters, players, and collection context.

Example:

Recommended: Cascadia

Why this fits:

- Works well for 3 players
- Usually takes your group under 45 minutes
- Easy to teach
- Karen and Charlotte have both reacted positively before
- You haven't played it in 2 months

10. Ratings and Reactions

Game Rating

Each game has a private 1–6 rating represented as a die face.

Die Rating	Meaning
🎲 1	Would avoid
🎲 2	Not for me
🎲 3	Okay
🎲 4	Good
🎲 5	Great
🎲 6	Favorite / always want to play

Session Reaction

Each play session can include a lightweight reaction:

- Thumbs up
- Neutral
- Thumbs down

This is separate from the overall game rating.

Privacy

Ratings and reactions are private by default. Shared session reactions may be visible to confirmed participants depending on session settings.

11. Play Logging

Quick Log

Users should be able to log a play with minimal input:

- Game
- Date, defaulting to today
- Played status

Full Log

Optional richer fields:

- Players
- Winner
- Scores
- Duration
- Location
- Play mode: solo, cooperative, competitive, team
- Notes
- Photos
- Player-specific ratings or reactions
- Teaching difficulty
- Setup/cleanup experience
- Rules issues
- Expansion/module used

Log Play Flow

1. User selects Log Play.
 2. User selects a game.
 3. Date defaults to today.
 4. User optionally adds players.
 5. User optionally adds winner, scores, duration, notes, and photos.
 6. User adds session reaction.
 7. User chooses whether to share with participants.
 8. Session is saved.
 9. Game play history and played-data shelves update automatically.
-

12. Player Profiles and Session Sharing

Player Profile Types

App User

A registered account that can:

- View shared sessions.

- Confirm participation.
- Add a session reaction.
- View session details.

Local Player Profile

A reusable player profile created by the collection owner for fast logging.

Examples:

- Karen
- Trevor
- Charlotte
- Guest Player
- Game Night Friend

Local profiles should be linkable to app user accounts later without losing session history.

Player Preferences

Player profiles can store manually entered and inferred preferences.

Preference Type	Examples
Favorite games	Cascadia, Ticket to Ride
Disliked games	Heavy conflict games
Preferred complexity	Light, medium, heavy
Preferred play style	Cooperative, competitive, party, strategy
Age / fit level	Kid, tween, teen, adult
Time comfort	Under 30 minutes, 60 minutes, long games okay
Teach comfort	Familiar only, okay learning new games
Inferred preferences	Often gives thumbs up to cooperative games

Session Sharing

Collections remain private in MVP. Session sharing is supported.

When a session is shared, invited participants can:

- View the session.
- Confirm they played.

- Add thumbs up / neutral / thumbs down reaction.

Participants should not be able to edit the owner's collection.

13. Collection Health Insights

Core Principle

The app should help users understand and improve their collection over time, not just store records.

Insight Types

Insight	Example
Unplayed games	"You own 14 games you haven't played yet."
Not played recently	"These favorites haven't hit the table in 6+ months."
Duplicate role games	"You have several light tile-laying games for 2–4 players."
Sell/trade candidates	"Low rating + not played in 12 months."
Missing metadata	"12 games need age range or player count."
Expansion relationships	"This expansion is missing a linked base game."
Collection balance	"You have many 2-player games, fewer 5+ player options."
Shelf cleanup	"These games match your Family shelf rules but are not included."

Insight Views

The product should support multiple views:

Dashboard View

High-level health overview.

Examples:

- Total games owned
- Unplayed games
- Not played in 12+ months

- Missing metadata
- Sell/trade candidates
- Campaigns in progress

Task View

Actionable cleanup list.

Examples:

- Add missing age range
- Confirm edition
- Link expansion to base game
- Review games not played recently
- Add shelves to new games

Shelf View

Insights embedded into relevant shelves.

Examples:

- Shelf of Shame
- Cull Candidates
- Needs Another Play
- Missing Metadata
- Unlinked Expansions

Game Detail View

Game-specific insight.

Examples:

- “You rated this , but your last three sessions were neutral.”
- “This game is often recommended but rarely selected.”
- “This may fit your Family Games shelf.”

14. Data Model Proposal

This is a product-level data model, not a technical schema.

User

Field	Description
user_id	Unique user identifier
display_name	User-facing name
email	Account email
auth_methods	Email/password, Google, Apple, Facebook
created_at	Account creation date
updated_at	Last account update

Collection

Field	Description
collection_id	Unique collection identifier
owner_user_id	Owner
name	Collection name
visibility	Private by default
created_at	Created date
updated_at	Last updated date

Game Metadata

Field	Description
game_metadata_id	Internal metadata record
bgg_id	BoardGameGeek identifier, if matched
title	Canonical title
alternate_titles	Alternate names
year_published	Publication year
min_players	Minimum player count
max_players	Maximum player count
best_player_count	Best count if available
min_age	Recommended minimum age
play_time_minutes	Typical play time
min_play_time	Minimum play time if available
max_play_time	Maximum play time if available
complexity_weight	Public complexity/weight value if available
designers	Designers
publishers	Publishers
categories	Categories
mechanics	Mechanics
families	Series/franchise/family data
image_url	Primary image
thumbnail_url	Thumbnail image
expansion_relationships	Base/expansion relationships
source	BGG or user-entered

Collection Game

Field	Description
collection_game_id	Unique record for a game in a user collection
collection_id	Associated collection
game_metadata_id	Linked public/manual metadata
ownership_status	Owned, wishlist, borrowed, etc.
play_status	Unplayed, played once, active, etc.
edition_notes	User notes on edition/version
condition	Condition
storage_location	Physical location
acquisition_date	Optional date acquired
acquisition_source	Optional source
personal_rating	1–6 die rating
user_notes	Private notes
user_overrides	User overrides for metadata
created_at	Created date
updated_at	Last updated date

Shelf

Field	Description
shelf_id	Unique shelf identifier
collection_id	Associated collection
name	Shelf name
shelf_type	Manual, tag-based, smart, hybrid
rules	Smart shelf rules if applicable
manual_inclusions	Games manually added
manual_exclusions	Games manually excluded
visibility	Private by default
created_at	Created date
updated_at	Last updated date

Tag

Field	Description
tag_id	Unique tag
collection_id	Associated collection
name	Tag name
description	Optional description

Player Profile

Field	Description
player_profile_id	Unique profile
owner_user_id	User who created the profile
linked_user_id	Optional linked app user
display_name	Player name
age_group	Optional age group
manual_preferences	User-entered preferences
inferred_preferences	System-inferred preferences
created_at	Created date
updated_at	Last updated date

Play Session

Field	Description
session_id	Unique session
collection_game_id	Game played
owner_user_id	User who logged session
played_at	Date/time
duration_minutes	Optional duration
location	Optional location
play_mode	Solo, cooperative, competitive, team
winner	Optional winner
scores	Optional scores
notes	Optional notes
photos	Optional photos
shared	Whether session was shared
created_at	Created date
updated_at	Last updated date

Session Participant

Field	Description
session_participant_id	Unique participant record
session_id	Associated session
player_profile_id	Local or linked player
linked_user_id	Optional user account
participation_status	Invited, confirmed, declined
reaction	Thumbs up, neutral, thumbs down
notes	Optional participant note

15. BoardGameGeek Mapping Proposal

The app should maintain its own user-centered data model while mapping to BoardGameGeek where possible.

Mapping Principles

1. BoardGameGeek is the primary public metadata source for MVP.
2. User collection data remains the source of truth.
3. Users can override imported fields.
4. If no BoardGameGeek match exists, users can create full manual records.
5. The product should store the BGG ID when available to allow metadata refresh later.
6. BGG data should be cached or synchronized according to technical and policy constraints determined later.

Proposed BGG Mapping

Product Field	BGG Equivalent / Source Concept	Notes
bgg_id	BGG object ID	Primary external identifier
title	Primary name	User can override display title
alternate_titles	Alternate names	Useful for search
year_published	Year published	Imported when available
min_players	Min players	Used for filters and shelves
max_players	Max players	Used for filters and shelves
best_player_count	Poll / community recommendation if available	Should be treated as public guidance, not absolute
min_age	Minimum age	User can override with household experience
play_time_minutes	Playing time	May also map min/max play time
complexity_weight	Average weight	Should not replace user teach difficulty
designers	Linked designer credits	Metadata shelf option
publishers	Linked publisher credits	Metadata shelf option
categories	Categories	Metadata shelf option
mechanics	Mechanics	Metadata shelf option
families	Family / series data	Useful for franchises and series
image_url	Image	Display asset
thumbnail_url	Thumbnail	List display
expansions	Expansion relationships	Supports base/expansion linking
public_rating	BGG rating if available	Should be visually secondary to user rating
public_rank	BGG rank if available	Not central to MVP

User Overrides

Users can override:

- Title

- Player count
 - Best player count
 - Age fit
 - Play time
 - Complexity / teach difficulty
 - Publisher/edition notes
 - Expansion relationship
 - Image, if manual image support exists later
-

16. CSV Import and Export

CSV Import Strategy

MVP should support a prescribed CSV template controlled by the product.

The product should not attempt to support every BoardGameGeek export or arbitrary spreadsheet format in MVP.

Required CSV Columns

```
title,ownership_status,play_status,personal_rating,shelves,tags
```

Optional CSV Columns

```
bgg_id,edition,year_published,min_players,max_players,best_player_count,min_age
```

Import Flow

1. User downloads CSV template.
2. User fills in collection data.
3. User uploads CSV.
4. App validates required fields.
5. App attempts BGG matching for rows without `bgg_id`.
6. User resolves ambiguous matches.
7. App imports games and assigns shelves/tags.
8. App reports errors, skipped rows, and successful imports clearly.

Export Requirements

Users should be able to export:

- Full collection
- Shelves and tags
- Personal ratings
- Play history
- Session participants
- Session reactions
- Notes
- Player profiles and preferences

Export Formats

- CSV for spreadsheet use.
 - JSON for full backup and migration.
-

17. Privacy, Accounts, Security, and Data Control

Account Requirements

MVP includes accounts and cloud sync.

Supported sign-in methods:

- Email/password
- Google login
- Apple login
- Facebook login

Additional account requirements:

- Password reset
- Email verification
- Ability to link/unlink social login later
- Collection data tied to authenticated account
- Private collections by default

Privacy Requirements

- Collections are private by default.
- Game ratings are private by default.
- Player notes are private by default.
- Session reactions are private unless shared in a shared session context.
- Session sharing should not expose private collection data.
- Shared session participants should only see the session details needed for that session.

Data Control Requirements

Users can delete:

- A single game record
- A shelf
- A player profile
- A play session
- Their full collection
- Their full account and associated data

Shared Session Deletion Considerations

The product should clearly define what happens when data involved in shared sessions is deleted.

Possible rule:

- If a user deletes their account, their personal data and reactions are removed or anonymized.
 - Shared session records may remain for other confirmed participants, but the deleted user should no longer be identifiable unless legally or technically required.
 - Before deletion, the product must clearly explain what will happen.
-

18. MVP Screen Inventory

Home

The home screen is a decision hub with two primary paths:

1. Manage Collection
2. Play

Example sections:

Home

Manage Collection

- Add a game
- View all games
- Review unplayed games
- Organize shelves
- Fix missing metadata
- Manage sell/trade/lent out

Play

- Find something to play
- Resume campaign
- Quick picks
- Family game night
- Recently played
- Log a play

Collection

Browse, search, filter, sort, and manage owned games.

Key actions:

- Search collection
- Filter collection
- Sort collection
- Open game detail
- Add game
- Import CSV
- Export collection

Game Detail

View and manage:

- Public metadata
- User overrides
- Ownership status
- Play status
- Shelves
- Tags
- Personal die rating
- Play history
- Collection insights
- Actions: log play, edit, delete

Shelves

Browse manual, smart, and hybrid shelves.

Key actions:

- View shelf
- Create shelf
- Edit shelf rules
- Add/remove games
- Save filters as shelf

Shelf Detail

View shelf contents and logic.

Key details:

- Shelf name
- Shelf type
- Matching rules
- Games included
- Manually pinned games
- Manually excluded games
- Suggested cleanup actions

Add Game

Add by:

- Search/import from BGG
- Manual entry
- CSV import

Future:

- Barcode scan
- Photo scan

Find a Game

Filter-driven play selection.

Key actions:

- Select players
- Apply filters
- View matching games
- View recommendation explanations
- Start or log session

Log Play

Supports quick and detailed logging.

Key actions:

- Select game
- Confirm date
- Add players
- Add reaction
- Add optional details
- Share session

Player Profiles

Manage reusable player profiles.

Key actions:

- Add profile

- Link to user account later
- Add manual preferences
- View inferred preferences
- View session history

Data Controls

Manage:

- Export
 - Delete records
 - Delete collection
 - Delete account
 - Privacy settings
-

19. Navigation Diagram

flowchart TD

Home --> ManageCollection[Manage Collection]

Home --> Play[Play]

ManageCollection --> Collection[Collection]

ManageCollection --> Shelves[Shelves]

ManageCollection --> AddGame[Add Game]

ManageCollection --> Insights[Collection Health]

ManageCollection --> DataControls[Data Controls]

Play --> FindGame[Find a Game]

Play --> LogPlay[Log Play]

Play --> RecentSessions[Recent Sessions]

Collection --> GameDetail[Game Detail]

Shelves --> ShelfDetail[Shelf Detail]

AddGame --> MatchGame[Confirm BGG Match]

AddGame --> ManualEntry[Manual Entry]

FindGame --> RecommendationResults[Recommendation Results]

RecommendationResults --> GameDetail

GameDetail --> LogPlay

LogPlay --> SessionDetail[Session Detail]

RecentSessions --> SessionDetail

SessionDetail --> ShareSession[Share Session]

20. Key User Flow Diagrams

Add a Game

```
flowchart TD
    Start[User chooses Add Game] --> Method{Add method}
    Method --> Search[Search BoardGameGeek]
    Method --> Manual[Manual Entry]
    Method --> CSV[CSV Import]

    Search --> Results[Show Possible Matches]
    Results --> Confirm[User Confirms Match]
    Confirm --> Autofill[Autofill Metadata]
    Manual --> RequiredFields[Complete Required Fields]
    CSV --> Validate[Validate CSV Rows]
    Validate --> Resolve[Resolve Missing or Ambiguous Matches]

    Autofill --> Review[Review Required Fields]
    RequiredFields --> Review
    Resolve --> Review

    Review --> Status[Set Ownership and Play Status]
    Status --> SmartShelves[Auto-Assign Smart Shelves]
    SmartShelves --> ManualShelves[Choose Manual Shelves]
    ManualShelves --> Save[Save Game to Collection]
```

Create a Shelf

```
flowchart TD
    Start[User Chooses Create Shelf] --> Type{Shelf Type}
    Type --> Manual[Manual Shelf]
    Type --> Smart[Smart Shelf]
    Type --> Hybrid[Hybrid Shelf]

    Manual --> AddGames[Manually Add Games]
    Smart --> DefineRules[Define Rules and Filters]
    Hybrid --> DefineRules
    DefineRules --> Preview[Preview Matching Games]
    Preview --> Adjust[Adjust Rules]
    Adjust --> PinExclude[Pin or Exclude Games]
    AddGames --> Save[Save Shelf]
    PinExclude --> Save
```

Find Something to Play

```
flowchart TD
    Start[User Chooses Find a Game] --> Players[Select Players]
    Players --> Filters[Apply Filters]
    Filters --> Results[View Matching Games]
    Results --> Explain[View Why This Fits]
    Explain --> Choose{Choose Game?}
    Choose -->|Yes| StartSession[Start or Log Session]
    Choose -->|No| Refine[Refine Filters]
    Refine --> Results
```

Log a Play

```
flowchart TD
    Start[User Chooses Log Play] --> Game[Select Game]
    Game --> Date[Confirm Date]
    Date --> Details{Quick or Full Log?}
    Details --> Quick[Minimum Details]
    Details --> Full[Players, Scores, Duration, Notes]
    Quick --> Reaction[Add Session Reaction]
    Full --> Reaction
    Reaction --> Share{Share Session?}
    Share -->|Yes| Invite[Invite Participants]
    Share -->|No| Save[Save Session]
    Invite --> Save
    Save --> Update[Update Play History and Shelves]
```

Export or Delete Data

```
flowchart TD
    Start[User Opens Data Controls] --> Choice{Export or Delete?}
    Choice --> Export[Choose Export Scope]
    Choice --> Delete[Choose Delete Scope]

    Export --> Format[Choose CSV or JSON]
    Format --> Generate[Generate Export]
    Generate --> Complete[Export Complete]

    Delete --> Explain[Show Consequences]
    Explain --> Confirm[User Confirms]
    Confirm --> Process[Delete or Anonymize Data]
    Process --> CompleteDelete[Deletion Complete]
```

21. Key Product Considerations

Detailed acceptance criteria should be created later during backlog development. The PRD should highlight key considerations.

Collection Management

- Required fields should not make adding games feel tedious.
- Imported BGG data should be editable.
- Users must be able to manually enter games that do not exist in BGG.
- The user's collection data is the source of truth.

Shelves

- Smart shelves should be understandable.
- Users should be able to see why a game appears on a smart shelf.
- Hybrid shelves should support manual pinning and exclusion.
- Shelves should work as both organization and decision-support tools.

Recommendations

- Recommendations should be filter-driven.
- The app should explain why a game fits.
- The user should control the importance of criteria.
- The system should not feel like a mysterious black box.

Play Logging

- Quick logging must be fast.
- Full logging should be available but optional.
- Player profiles should reduce repetitive entry.
- Session reactions should be lightweight.

Sharing

- Collection sharing is out of MVP.
- Session sharing is in MVP.
- Shared sessions should not expose the full collection.
- Participants can view, confirm, and react.

Data Control

- Export and deletion should be easy to find.
 - Deletion consequences must be clear.
 - Users should be able to retrieve and control their data.
 - Shared-session deletion behavior must be explicitly defined.
-

22. Research and Validation Plan

Research Goals

1. Validate whether users understand and value shelves.
2. Validate whether smart shelves feel helpful or confusing.
3. Determine whether the add-game flow feels complete but not tedious.
4. Test whether users can find something to play quickly.
5. Validate whether session logging is lightweight enough to become a habit.
6. Test whether players trust recommendation explanations.
7. Validate whether export/delete controls increase trust.

Suggested Interview Questions

Collection Management

- How do you currently track your board game collection?
- What makes your current system frustrating?
- How do you decide where a game belongs in your collection?
- Do you think in terms of shelves, tags, lists, or categories?
- What collection details do you care about most?

Play Selection

- How do you decide what to play on a game night?
- What factors matter most when choosing a game?
- Who usually makes the decision?
- What makes choosing a game difficult?
- Would explanations make recommendations feel more trustworthy?

Play Tracking

- Do you currently log plays?

- What would make logging plays worth the effort?
- What is the minimum information you would want to capture?
- Would thumbs up / neutral / thumbs down be enough for a session reaction?

Data Trust

- Would you import your collection into a new tool?
- What would make you trust the tool with your collection data?
- How important is export?
- How important is full deletion?

Prototype Testing Tasks

- Add 5 games to your collection.
- Create a shelf for family game night.
- Create a smart shelf for 3–4 player games under 60 minutes.
- Find a game for 4 players under 60 minutes.
- Log a play session.
- Share a session with another participant.
- Export your collection.
- Delete one game record.
- Explain why a recommended game appeared.

Success Signals

Area	Signal
Add Game	Users can add games without needing help.
Metadata	Users understand imported vs. personal data.
Shelves	Users can explain the difference between manual and smart shelves.
Filtering	Users can find a suitable game for a scenario.
Recommendation Trust	Users understand and value “why this fits.”
Play Logging	Users complete quick logging without friction.
Session Sharing	Participants understand how to confirm and react.
Data Control	Users can export/delete without confusion.

23. MVP Success Metrics

These metrics should be refined once implementation and analytics planning begin.

Area	Possible Metric
Collection Setup	Percentage of users who add 10+ games
Data Completeness	Percentage of games with player count, age, playtime, status, and shelves
Shelf Usefulness	Number of shelves created or used per user
Smart Shelf Value	Percentage of users who view or save smart shelves
Play Selection	Number of “Find a Game” searches completed
Recommendation Trust	Percentage of recommendations where users view “why this fits”
Play Tracking	Number of sessions logged per active user
Session Sharing	Percentage of logged sessions shared with another participant
Data Trust	Number of exports completed and successful deletion flows
Retention	Users returning to manage or log plays after initial setup

24. Proposed Definition of Done for MVP

The MVP is ready when a user can:

1. Create an account and securely access their collection.
2. Add games manually or through BoardGameGeek matching.
3. Import collection data using the prescribed CSV format.
4. Export collection and play data.
5. Organize games into manual and smart shelves.
6. Use hybrid shelf behavior with pinning or exclusion.
7. Filter their collection to find suitable games.
8. View recommendations with clear reasons.

9. Log a play with minimum input.
 10. Add optional richer session detail.
 11. Include reusable player profiles in sessions.
 12. Share a session with participants.
 13. Let participants view, confirm, and react to a shared session.
 14. Rate games with a 1–6 die rating.
 15. React to sessions with thumbs up, neutral, or thumbs down.
 16. View collection-health insights.
 17. Delete individual records.
 18. Delete their account and associated data.
 19. Understand what happens to shared session data during deletion.
-

25. Agent Role for Future Product Work

A separate agent prompt should be created after this PRD is reviewed.

The product agent should assist with:

- Refining the PRD.
- Challenging scope creep politely.
- Creating user stories after the PRD is polished.
- Creating acceptance criteria later.
- Creating data schema proposals.
- Creating BGG mapping details.
- Creating CSV templates.
- Drafting UX flows.
- Drafting wireframe descriptions.
- Creating implementation handoff prompts for a development agent.
- Reviewing product ideas against personas.
- Maintaining clear MVP vs. later distinction.

The agent should not:

- Write production code.
- Make final technical stack decisions without approval.
- Expand scope into social/community features too early.
- Assume unavailable APIs or integrations.

- Treat BGG data as more authoritative than user-entered data.
-

26. Open Questions

These questions should be resolved during PRD review or later planning.

1. What is the product name?
 2. Should campaign/legacy tracking be MVP or later?
 3. What exact CSV fields should be required vs. optional?
 4. Should manual shelves and tags be separate concepts or the same underlying model?
 5. How should shared-session deletion behave in edge cases?
 6. Should session reactions be visible to all participants or only the session owner?
 7. How should the app handle players who are children or household members?
 8. Should collection-level sharing remain fully out of MVP?
 9. Should photo/barcode add be moved into MVP if technically easy?
 10. What level of BGG metadata refresh should be supported?
 11. Should imported BGG public ratings be displayed at all, or hidden to keep focus on personal ratings?
 12. How much collection-health insight is needed for MVP vs. later?
 13. What analytics events are needed to measure MVP success?
 14. What legal/privacy requirements apply to stored player profiles and shared sessions?
 15. What should the first prototype include for usability testing?
-

27. Recommended Next Step

Review this PRD for scope, clarity, and missing assumptions.

After the PRD is polished, create:

1. A prioritized MVP backlog.
2. Jira-style user stories.
3. Acceptance criteria.

4. Product-agent prompt.
5. Development-agent handoff prompt.